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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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Submitter Information

Email: [REDACTED]
Organization: AI Salon

General Comment

See attached file(s)

Attachments

AI Salon Response to WH AI RFI



March 15, 2025

Faisal D'Souza
National Coordinator Office
Networking and Information Technology Research and Development Program
National Science Foundation
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA 22314

RE: Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

Dear Mr. D'Souza,

On behalf of the [AI Salon](#) (the Salon), a community of more than 3,000 AI optimists collaboratively exploring the power of generative AI, I am writing in response to the National Science Foundation's (NSF) *Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan*. At the Salon, we are committed to ensuring that artificial intelligence (AI) is developed and deployed in a way that promotes ethical integrity, social responsibility, and inclusive governance. AI has the transformative potential to drive positive change in the world, so we ask that you consider our recommendations to ensure that AI is guided by responsible principles and practices.

Ensuring fairness, transparency, and societal good

Among our core values, AI Salon's members are invested in using AI for societal good. In December 2023, the Salon hosted #GPT4Good, a 24-hour collaboration that produced 150 custom chatbots for non-profit organizations.

To that end, we advocate for AI systems free from harmful biases and designed to be transparent and accountable. AI should be developed with fairness in mind, ensuring that it benefits all people, regardless of background, identity, or circumstance. As the NSF and the Trump Administration consider AI regulation, we urge you to support policies that promote the use of AI for societal good—whether in healthcare, education, or environmental sustainability—that balance both holding bad actors accountable and encouraging innovation.

Promoting a collaborative AI regulatory framework

As mindful optimists, the Salon is invested in fostering an environment where AI can flourish safely. We support thoughtful regulation that promotes AI development and adoption by small enterprises and addresses AI risks. We urge the Administration to include small enterprises and diverse founders in all policy discussions to ensure guidelines that adequately promote responsible AI development and deployment across *all* players.

Additionally, the Salon supports developing national standards that govern AI's ethical deployment. In 2024, over 700 AI bills were introduced in state legislatures, and 2025 is expected to supersede that number. These bills are rarely uniform in their definitions and requirements, creating a worrisome patchwork of complex and burdensome requirements. Our members' innovative work is seldom limited to the boundaries of one state, and this patchwork of regulations would particularly affect small founders who do not have the financial and staffing resources to comply. To that end, we recommend that the Administration collaborate with the startup community and the public sector to harmonize national AI standards and develop safety practices.

Protecting personal data and safeguarding security

Data privacy and security are paramount in the age of AI. We advocate for policies that ensure AI systems handle personal data with the utmost care, with clear rules on data ownership and consent. Stronger protections are needed to guard against AI-driven cyberattacks and misinformation. We recommend that the Administration address these concerns through a national policy framework to help consumers better understand their rights and support comprehensive AI deployment.

Balancing creativity and innovation

As AI-generated content becomes more prevalent, we must address the ownership and copyright implications for creators and developers. We support fair intellectual property laws that balance the rights of traditional artists, content creators, and AI developers. Additionally, we advocate for updating patent laws to reflect the role of AI in innovation while ensuring that the process remains open and accessible to all.

Preparing workers for an AI-driven future

The rise of AI brings both opportunity and challenge. AI literacy is crucial for everyone—from policymakers to everyday citizens. We advocate for expanding AI education at all levels of society, from introductory courses to advanced training for professionals. Additionally, we believe that companies must take corporate responsibility for ensuring their employees understand AI's technical and ethical aspects, fostering a workforce that can make informed, ethical decisions.

To ensure workers have the tools to succeed in new AI-enhanced roles, we urge the Administration to invest in reskilling initiatives, workforce transition plans, and educational programming to prepare students for future workforce needs.

Enhancing democratic processes with AI tools

We see AI as a powerful tool to improve governance. We support the use of AI-assisted governance to optimize policy design, resource allocation, and public health responses. However, this should be done transparently and in a way that promotes public participation. We recommend that the Administration study how AI can be used to enhance public consultation models, allowing citizens to engage meaningfully in policy development while safeguarding privacy and fairness.

Greening AI for a sustainable future

AI can contribute to and help mitigate the environmental impact of technological development. We recommend that the Administration support policies that address large AI models' carbon footprint and encourage energy-efficient AI development practices. Additionally, we support the use of AI in tackling climate change, from optimizing energy use to predicting and mitigating environmental risks, ensuring that AI becomes a tool for sustainability.

Ensuring AI systems are safe and beneficial

As AI becomes more complex and autonomous, we must ensure that it remains safe and aligned with human values. We advocate for policies that ensure robust AI design, preventing harmful behaviors and ensuring systems act as intended. We also support policies that promote human-AI collaboration, ensuring that AI augments human decision-making and does not replace it, fostering a future where AI enhances human capabilities rather than undermines them.

Thank you for the opportunity to respond to this request for comments and we ask that you please consider our recommendations. We welcome the opportunity to further this conversation, so please feel free to reach out to Kathy Orellana at [REDACTED] if you have any questions.

Sincerely,
Daisy Thomas
Leader, AI Salon Policy & Civic Engagement Guild